- If the uploaded Microsoft Excel file contains the same charge type or a condition type repeated more than once, the system does not upload the entire file.

Discover Business Partners

Finding the right business partners is always a challenge. However, this will be easier once your partners-to-be have joined SAP Business Network for Logistics.

As a simple yet powerful app in SAP Business Network for Logistics, **Discover Business Partners** helps you search the network for logistics service providers, then from the results, invite suitable ones to be your business partners.

Prerequisites

To use this app, you must add one or several roles to your role collection. The required role templates and application identifiers are described in the Available Roles for Shippers section of the Administration Guide for Shippers.

Search for Business Partners

To search for business partners on the network, enter a key word, for example the company name, in the search box and then press Enter. You can also use faceted search on the left pane to narrow down your search results. When using faceted search, you can even leave the search box empty. This is useful if you want to explore your potential partners in a specific region or industry.

Note

If the business partners you are trying to connect with operates in a different data center, you must first ensure that your company profile is available across all data centers of SAP Business Network for Logistics. For more information, refer to Profile Settings.

Result

A set of matched results are returned. You can click to open the details page of a matched result.

Note

If the companies that match your search conditions are not found, see Discover Business Partners App and refer to "Why companies that match my search conditions are not returned in the Matched Results table?"

Send Request for Connection

To send a request for connection to your potential business partners, proceed as follows:

1. Click to select the company to which you want to send the request for connection from the **Matched Results** table.
2. Choose **Request for Connection**. The request for connection is sent to the selected companies.

Results

A request for connection is sent to the selected company. Once the company accepts your request, you will become business partners.

After you've set up a partnership with a business partner via this app, you must update the business partner's LBN ID in SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM). To do this, see Updating Business Partner's LBN ID.

References

Manage Business Profile

Manage Invitations

Updating Business Partner's LBN ID

To update the LBN ID in SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM) for a logistics service provider who's become your business partner, proceed as follows in SAP TM:

1. Go to the **Manage Business Partner** transaction (transaction BP).
2. Set the filter criteria to find the business partner for which you want to update the LBN ID and then double-click the business partner to open its **Display Organization** page.
3. Navigate to the **Identification** tab. In the **Identification Numbers** section, **IDType** field, enter `LBN001`.
4. In the **Identification Number** field, enter the LBN ID and save your changes.

Invite Business Partners

The **Invite Business Partners** app is designed for managing all the business partners that you want to be part of your network. You can use this app to select and invite business partners to join your business network and check their participation status. If you have access, you can navigate to the **Discover Business Partners** app to find more potential business partners.

ℹ Note

To use these apps, you must add one or several roles to your role collection. The required role templates and application identifiers are described in the Available Roles for Shippers section of the Administration Guide for Shippers.

You may have business with many partners in your system and you may want to persist your business with them in SAP Business Network for Logistics. You can download the Excel template available in the app and fill the details of the business partners using this template. You can then upload the template back in the app.

ℹ Note

- You must make sure that no personal data enters the system in an uncontrolled or non purpose-related way in the Microsoft Excel file.
- The file size of each business partners Excel cannot be larger than 2MB, and the maximum number of rows in each file is 5000.
- A digital freight forwarder is managed as a business partner in both the SAP Business Network for Logistics and SAP Transportation Management system.

If you are using SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM) system, you can download these business partners from SAP TM system and upload them in **Invite Business Partners**. For more information, see Downloading Carrier Excel from SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM).

You can select one or more of these business partners from your system and invite them to join your network. When you submit these partners, a back-end team manages your connection invitation. For more information, see Connection Invitations.

When a business partner accepts an invitation to connect with your network, the system updates the unique LBN ID of the partner. If you are using SAP TM system, you can update these LBN IDs of partners in SAP TM system by downloading the partner list from the

Discover Business Partners app and uploading the list in your SAP TM system. For more information, see Updating LBN IDs in SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM).

The **Discover Business Partners** app consists of the following areas:

- Filter bar

  You can filter the business partner based on one more of the filter options (**Business Partner ID** and **Business Partner**) that appear on the header area.

- Worklists by status

  The business partners are categorized based on their invitation response status: **To Be Submitted**, **In Progress**, **Accepted**, and **Rejected**.

Worklist (Manage Business Partners)

There are different ways to manage all the business partners and to set filters. To search for a specific business partner, you can use the filter bar in the header. The system also displays preconfigured worklists (**To Be Submitted**, **In Progress**, **Accepted**, **Rejected**) based on the business partner's invitation response status.

Filter Bar

With the filter bar, you can do the following:

- Specify filters to narrow down the worklists and search for business partners.
- Add or remove the filters displayed on the filter bar by choosing **Adapt Filters**.
- Save the current filter settings as a view and apply it later.

  After you specified filters (and pressed Enter) and/or adapted filter display, the current view name shown in the upper-left corner displays a * sign, indicating the view has been changed. Save the view by either of the following:

  - Click the view name to open the **My Views** box and choose **Save** or **Save As**.
  - In the **Adapt Filters** dialog box, choose **Save**.

  Next time when you want to apply the view, just select the view name in the **My Views** box.

> **Note**
> The default **Standard** view cannot be changed.

To Be Submitted

The **To Be Submitted** worklist displays all the business partners that you have uploaded or added in the app but have not yet submitted to the back-end team of SAP Business Network for Logistics to manage the connection invitations. This worklist also displays connection invitations that have been rejected. The worklist displays the following details for each invitation:

- System ID
- Business Partner ID
- Invitee
- Company Role
- SCAC (Standard Carrier Alpha Code)

- Phone number
- Email
- Language
- City
- Country/Region
- Zip code
- Status

ℹ Note

- A rejected invitation is displayed on the **To Be Submitted** worklist with the status "Returned by LBN OPS team" if it was submitted via the **Invite Business Partners** app.
- A rejected invitation is displayed on the **Rejected** worklist if it was submitted via the **Discover Business Partners** app.

In Progress

The **In Progress** worklist displays all the business partners that you have submitted to the back-end team to manage the connection invitations. These business partners have not yet responded to your invitation to connect with your network. You can recall your invitation in this worklist if needed.

The **In Progress** worklist has the same columns as the **To Be Submitted** worklist.

Accepted

The **Accepted** worklist displays all the business partners who have accepted your invitation to join your business network. You can select one or more business partners in the **Accepted** tab and download them in Microsoft Excel format.

The **Accepted** worklist has the same columns as the **In Progress** worklist along with the unique LBN ID of the business partner.

Rejected

The **Rejected** worklist displays all the business partners who have rejected your invitation to join your business network via **Discover Business Partners**.

The **Rejected** worklist has the same columns as the **Accepted** worklist.

Using the settings icon on each worklist, you can control the number of columns displayed in the **To Be Submitted**, **In Progress**, **Accepted**, and **Rejected** tabs.

You can also sort and filter the business partners in these worklists based on various attributes.

Add New Business Partners

You can add new business partners to the **Invite Business Partners** app in one of the following ways:

- Manual entry

On the **To Be Submitted** tab, you can manually add a new business partner to the **Invite Business Partners** app by choosing **Add Invitee** > **Business Partner**. You can also add a shipper to the app by choosing **Add Invitee** > **Shipper**. When adding a shipper, you must provide the shipper's LBN ID.

Using this method, you can specify the language of your connection invitations. Supported languages are:

- English
- Arabic
- Bulgarian
- Chinese Simplified
- Chinese Traditional
- Croatian
- Czech
- Danish
- Dutch
- Finnish
- French
- German
- Greek
- Hebrew
- Hungarian
- Italian
- Japanese
- Korean
- Malay
- Norwegian
- Polish
- Portuguese (Brazilian)
- Romanian
- Russian
- Serbian
- Slovak
- Spanish
- Swedish
- Thai
- Turkish

- Manual entry with an Excel template

You can download the Excel template available in the **Invite Business Partners** app by choosing the **Download Excel Template** button. You can fill the details of the business partners using this template. You can then upload this template back in the **Invite Business Partners** app.

- Downloading business partner Excel from SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM) system

  You can download the list of business partners in your SAP TM system and upload the Excel file in the **Invite Business Partners** app. For more information, see Download Carrier Excel from SAP Transportation Management System.

  Note

  - When you upload a business partner Excel in the **Invite Business Partners** app, the system automatically filters out the erroneous business partner records and selects only the correct business partner records. For example, in the downloaded Excel file, if there are business partners that already exist in the **Invite Business Partners** app with the status as **In Progress**, **Accepted** or **Rejected**, or if some of the entries do not contain any of the mandatory fields, the system ignores such entries and uploads all the other entries.
  - When you upload a business partner Excel, the system performs a validation. If there are no validation errors, the business partner Excel is uploaded. If there are validation errors, the system displays the erroneous entries in an error log. The system allows you to download this error log.
  - You must make sure that no personal data enters the system in an uncontrolled or non purpose-related way in the Microsoft Excel file.

You can select one or more business partners in the **To Be Submitted** worklist and delete them from the **Invite Business Partners** app. Note that you cannot delete the business partners that you have submitted to the back-end team of SAP Business Network for Logistics to manage the connection invitation.

Connection Invitations

Once you have a list of business partners added to the **Invite Business Partners** app, you can select one or more partners from the **To Be Submitted** worklist and choose **Submit**.

Once you choose **Submit**, the system instantaneously sends a request to the back-end team of SAP Business Network for Logistics to manage the connection invitation. The system moves the submitted business partners to the **In Progress** worklist.

Shippers in both production and test environments can use the Invite Business Partners app to send connection invitations to business partners. If the invitees are not yet on the network, they can activate their accounts via a simplified account activation process and collaborate with the inviter in the respective environment (either production or test). You can refer your invitees to the following resource for their account activation: Getting Started with SAP Business Network for Logistics via New Onboarding Process.

Note that business partners need your contact information when you send them an invitation to join your business network. If you have not maintained a default address in the **Manage Business Profile** app, the system does not allow you to submit business partners. For more information on adding a default address, see Edit Company Profile.

The back-end team sends an invitation to the business partners requesting them to connect with your network.

The business partner can view this connection invitation using the **Manage Invitations** app and choose to accept or reject the invitation. For more information, see Manage Invitations.

When the business partner accepts or rejects an invitation, you will be notified of the same and the system moves the business partner to the accepted or rejected worklist as appropriate. If a partner accepts your invitation, the partner connects with your network and you can perform business transactions with this partner. If a business partner rejects your invitation, the partner is not connected with your network and you cannot perform any business transactions with this partner. You can find the rejected invitation from the **To Be Submitted** worklist and resend it if you want to.

The system updates the unique LBN IDs of the business partners who have accepted your connection invitation. You can view this LBN ID in the **Accepted** worklist for each business partner.

If you are using SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM) system, you can update these LBN IDs of business partners in SAP TM system by downloading the business partner list from the **Invite Business Partners** app and uploading the list in your SAP TM system. For more information, see Updating LBN IDs in SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM).

Recall Invitations

You can recall a submitted invitation as long as its status remains "In Progress".

To recall the invitation, switch to the **In Progress** worklist, click to open the invitation that you want to recall, and then choose **Recall** on the details page.

Note

You can't recall an invitation when its status is "Invitation email sent to business partner".

After being recalled, the invitation returns to the **To Be Submitted** worklist and becomes editable. The business partner cannot view the recalled invitation using the app until you submit it again.

Downloading Business Partner Excel from SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM)

You can download the business partners from the SAP TM system and upload them to the **Invite Business Partners** app.

Context

In SAP TM system, you must perform the following steps to download the business partner Excel:

Procedure

1. Execute the report `/SCMTMS/R_LBN_CARR_LIST_DWNLD` in transaction `SE38`.
2. Enter your SAP TM organization ID in the **Organizational ID** field and execute.

   The system determines the hierarchy of this organization and retrieves all the freight agreements that are valid at the time of searching. The system then determines the valid business partners from these agreements.

   Note that if you select the **Show Application Log** checkbox, the system displays the detailed information about the business partner determination process.
3. Alternatively, instead of entering an organization ID and retrieving multiple business partners, you can also enter the business partner IDs in the Carrier IDs field and execute.

   The system retrieves the details of all the business partners that you have entered.
4. Select all the business partners that you want to download and then choose **Download**.

   The system downloads the Excel file.

Next Steps

Once you download the Excel file, in the **Invite Business Partners** app, choose the **Upload Business Partners** button to upload this Excel. Once you upload the Excel file with a list of partners, the system updates the **To Be Submitted** worklist in the app with the partner details in the Excel.

ℹ Note

System IDs may consist of alphanumerical characters and the underscore (_) character. You can check the Specification tab of the Excel for further guidance. The system checks all records when you upload your Excel, and displays the errors on the **Upload Business Partners** screen. You can correct the errors in your Excel and upload it again.

Updating LBN IDs in SAP Transportation Management (SAP TM)

You can update the SAP TM system with the unique LBN IDs of the business partners who have accepted to connect with your business network.

Context

To do so, you must perform the following:

Procedure

1. Download the list of business partners with their LBN IDs from the **Accepted** worklist in the **Invite Business Partners** app.

   The system downloads the list of partners in a CSV format.

2. In the SAP TM system, execute the report `/SCMTMS/R_LBN_ID_BP_UPD` in transaction `SA38`.
3. Browse for the CSV file that you have downloaded and upload the file.

   The system updates the business partner IDs for the partners in the system. Note that you can choose whether you want the system to process the upload job in the background or foreground. If you choose to process the upload job in the foreground, the system displays the error logs if there are any.

Configure Partner Connections

You can use the **Configure Partner Connections** app to establish a B2B connection to the external systems of your business partners. Using this configuration, SAP Business Network for Logistics can directly send documents to your partner's external systems.

Prerequisites

SAP Business Network for Logistics must support the desired business partner for B2B connectivity. This means that your company must agree on B2B integration with your carrier.

Then, you must invite your network partner to join SAP Business Network for Logistics using the **Invite Business Partners** app. Only then will the network partner be visible in the **Configure Partner Connections** app.

The process of using the **Configure Partner Connections** app to create a connection and to authenticate messages includes the following steps:

1. Manage Credential Details
2. Create Partner Connection

ℹ Note

To use this app, you must add one or several roles to your role collection. The required role templates and application identifiers are described in the Available Roles for Shippers section of the Administration Guide for Shippers.

Create Partner Connection

Context

Using the **Configure Partner Connections** app, you now need to map the connection details with your business partners and establish a B2B connection.

Procedure

1. In the **Configure Partner Connections** app, choose **Create**.
2. Provide the following information:

Field	Explanation	Usage (as maintained in **Manage Credential Details**)
Business Partner ID Type*	ID type of your individual connected business partner or of all connected business partners. A business partner is an entity with which the LBN customer does business (freight contracting, and order execution). You can maintain the following ID types: • LBN ID • SCAC • P44_EU • Motor Carrier Number • US DOT • GLN • VAT • SAPBPID – SAP Business Partner Number	You can choose between general ID types (**Any LBN ID** or **Any Alternate ID**) and specific ID types (such as **LBN ID**, **SCAC**, or **GLN**) for a connection with your business partners. **Any LBN ID** applies this setting to all business partners that are onboarded in the network and connected to your tenant. You can configure alternate business partner ID types to initiate tracking for your shipments. Onboarding of these business partners to SAP Business Network for Logistics is not required.
Business Partner ID Value*	Unique identifier representing the business partner.	Based on the business partner ID type, you choose the business partner ID value: • If you choose **LBN ID**, the field name is **Business Partner (LBN ID)**. • If you choose a different ID than **LBN ID**, the field name is **Business Partner ID Value**.
Network Partner (LBN ID)	LBN ID of your network partner. A network partner is an entity which does data transfer/integration to business partners. Network partners will have many business partners in their network and have built integrations to business partner systems.	You must provide this information if you receive the data via a network partner.
Service*	A service is defined based on the combination of the following information coming from a shipper:	SAP Business Network for Logistics supports the transportation modes *Road* and *Ocean* with the following services:

Field	Explanation	Usage (as maintained in Manage Credential Details)
	• *Tracking type*: Specifies if the tracking is based on a device or vehicle (such as the vehicle's license plate) or based on a shipment indicator (such as a bill of lading) • *Transportation mode* (such as *Road*) • *Scenario* (such as tracking) • *Shipping type* (such as LTL - less than truck load, or FTL - full truck load)	• Resource Road Tracking FTL (Removed) • Shipment Road Tracking LTL • Shipment Tracking All • Shipment Road Tracking FTL • Resource Road Tracking LTL (Removed) • Shipment Ocean Tracking FCL • Resource Ocean Tracking FCL (Removed) • Shipment Ocean Tracking LCL • Resource Ocean Tracking LCL (Removed) • Resource Tracking All (Removed) • Freight Tendering All • Freight Subcontracting All • Supply Chain Risk • Freight Ocean Booking All • Freight Air Booking All • Freight Road Subcontracting FTL • Freight Road Subcontracting LTL • Freight Road Tendering FTL • Freight Road Tendering LTL • Freight External Planning All **⚠ Caution** Resource tracking related services have been removed on August 17th, 2024. You can use the shipment tracking related services instead. **i Note** Only those services that are supported by your business partner will be shown in the dropdown box.
Business Partner Credential	Credential provided to you by your business partner, which is maintained in the Manage Credential Details view.	You must maintain this field if you communicate directly with your business partner's system.
Network Partner Credential	Credential provided to you by your network partner, which is maintained in the Manage Credential Details view.	You must provide this information if you are communicating with your business partner via a network partner.